

with different properties to see how this can be achieved. It's a fun opportunity to try new things!

It was a really difficult challenge, we had to do a few hours of research to understand all the different properties and then executing it perfectly was another pain. We hope you didn't have as tough a time as we did. How was your experience trying to solve this mystery?

(If you didn't already solve the puzzle, read on where we reveal how to do it)

Haha, gotcha!

This couldn't have been easier. Animating the Logo text is the only new thing we have to figure out and once you select 'APEAK' to make it the active layer, all you need to do is look at the properties under Transform and right from the get-go is obvious that you just have to utilise the 'Opacity' property.

The text is already set to appear on-screen with a delay, so you don't even have to move the time-bar. Just set the Opacity to 0 when it appears on screen and click on the stopwatch to its right to set a keyframe. (This will place a keyframe on the Opacity time frame at this particular point and then move the active time bar to a few seconds later and click on the stopwatch symbol again to cement another keyframe. (It's also interesting to note that the stopwatch symbol turns from grey to blue).

Now, if you hit the space bar, you will see a seamless transition where the logo moves up and the logo name beautifully fades in. Again, you can play around with different opacities and see what this does, try bringing on a subtler logo or try creating a strobing effect that gives it a more vibrant feel.

(Just be careful when you set the keyframe as it will be set at the point the blue time indicator is)

4) Adding a Visual Effect

After Effects has limitless options to add visual effects, so let's just try a simple blur effect. We'll have to select the Summer_Forest video in the background first. The next step is to choose Effect → Blur and Sharpen → Fast Box Blur. This doesn't immediately carry over to the video. A new Effects Controls panel opens up. Some of these controls have to be adjusted to get the outcome we desire. Due to the addition of a new panel, the Project and Composition panel are both reduced in size to accommodate for this change.

A very intriguing observance here is that all the features and options are available simultaneously on both the Effects Control panel as well as